

MSK 6 – Research Project: Fairwork Pilots — Assessment Brief & Marking Rubric

Assessment: Final Presentation (100%)

In this module you design and complete a small empirical research project on fairness in the platform/gig economy, using the Fairwork principles (Fair Pay, Fair Conditions, Fair Contracts, Fair Management, Fair Representation) as your main analytical lens.

You are supported through weekly workshops and lectures, a 1-page mini-proposal, supervision meetings/ongoing feedback as requested, progress reflection sheets, dedicated deep-work sessions in class, and three formative checkpoints (proposal, plan presentation, draft results) that prepare you directly for the graded task.

In MSK 6 you demonstrate your learning through a **final presentation (100%)** that shows your ability to communicate your research and findings in a concise, engaging, visual, and audience-friendly way. Your talk should highlight your key question, methods, and findings, and explain why they matter for Fairwork in practice in conversational and engaging language.

Final Presentation – Task Description

You will give a short presentation (approx. 10–15 minutes) covering:

- **A. Title, Topic & Context**
Who/what your project is about, and 1–2 sentences on why this matters in the platform/gig economy.
- **B. Research Question & Fairwork Principle**
One clear research question, and how it links to at least one Fairwork principle.
- **C. Method & Data**
What you did, with whom/what, and why this was feasible and ethical in one semester.
- **D. Key Findings with Evidence**
2–4 key findings supported by simple evidence (e.g. quotes, tables, graphs).
- **E. Reflection & Next Steps**
Your contribution to understanding fairness in this case, main limitations, and ideas for future research or practice.

You must follow XU's academic integrity rules (proper citation, no plagiarism, correct use of AI according to university guidelines), and Fairwork ethical standards for research with workers and sensitive topics

How your work will be assessed

This rubric below shows how your presentation will be evaluated on four criteria.

For each criterion, the examiner will decide whether your work is at level **0–4** (from **Fail** to **Excellent**). These levels are then combined and converted into the official **German grade (1.0–5.0)** for the module, following XU's grading regulations.

The table below gives **approximate bands** so you can see how overall rubric performance translates into the German grading scale. Exact boundaries may be adjusted slightly in line with university rules, but the basic idea is:

- Mostly level 3–4 = a grade in the **1.x** range
- Mostly level 2 = a grade in the **2.x** range
- Mostly level 1 = a grade in the **3–4** range
- Below level 1 overall = **fail**

Approximate conversion from rubric score to German grade

Overall rubric score (0–4)	Description of performance	Approx. German grade band
3.7 – 4.0	Excellent	1.0 – 1.3
3.3 – 3.6	Very good	about 1.7
2.7 – 3.2	Good	2.0 – 2.3
2.0 – 2.6	Satisfactory	about 2.7 – 3.0
1.5 – 1.9	Sufficient	about 3.3 – 3.7
1.0 – 1.4	Barely sufficient	about 4.0
below 1.0	Fail	worse than 4.0

You should mainly use the descriptions in the rubrics on the following pages to guide your preparation. The conversion table is there to help you understand how rubric performance roughly maps onto the German grading system.

Final Presentation Rubric (100%)

Scale

- 0 = Fail (no or very weak evidence)
- 1 = Pass (minimum, basic)
- 2 = Good
- 3 = Very Good
- 4 = Excellent

Criterion 1: Research Question & Fairwork Relevance – *How clearly you communicate the core idea on screen and out loud.*

- **0 – Fail:** The research question is not stated, is very unclear, or contradicts what is shown on the slides; Fairwork is missing or obviously misused.
- **1 – Pass:** A research question appears on a slide or is said, but it is vague, multi-part, or hard to follow; a Fairwork principle is named, but the connection is only a label.
- **2 – Good:** One clear research question is visible and spoken; at least one Fairwork principle is correctly identified and briefly linked to the topic.
- **3 – Very Good:** A focused, realistic research question is introduced early and referred back to; the chosen Fairwork principle(s) are explained in concrete terms using your case or examples.
- **4 – Excellent:** A sharp, well-scoped research question is presented in a way that the audience immediately understands; the talk shows a nuanced grasp of how this question engages specific Fairwork criteria and real platform/gig situations.

Criterion 2: Methods, Ethics & Feasibility – *How clearly you tell the story of what you actually did and why it was doable and ethical.*

- **0 – Fail:** The audience cannot tell what method you used or how you collected data; ethical issues are ignored; the project appears clearly unrealistic for one semester.
- **1 – Pass:** You mention a method (e.g. “I did a survey”) but give little detail; it is unclear who or what is included; ethics and practical limits are only briefly name-dropped.
- **2 – Good:** You explain, in simple language, who/what your data come from (e.g. how many participants, which documents/platforms) and how you approached them; you briefly describe key ethical steps and show that the plan was realistic.
- **3 – Very Good:** The presentation clearly walks the audience through your design: why this method, how you recruited or selected cases, what tools you used; you explicitly address consent, anonymity, and personal safety; the timeline and scale sound well matched to the semester.
- **4 – Excellent:** You give a concise, confident account of your design and fieldwork that makes sense for a BA project; you openly discuss constraints and adjustments you made; ethics, data protection, and feasibility are integrated into the story rather than added as an afterthought.

Criterion 3: Data Analysis & Interpretation – *How clearly you show your data and explain what it means.*

- **0 – Fail:** Slides only show isolated numbers or quotes without any structure; there is no explanation of patterns; the audience cannot see how this relates to your question or Fairwork.

- **1 – Pass:** You present some simple figures or quotes, but they are crowded, confusing, or barely interpreted; the link to the research question is weak or only mentioned at the end.
- **2 – Good:** You show basic but readable visuals or grouped quotes (e.g. simple bar chart, table, or 2–3 themes); you explain a few main patterns and connect them to your question and chosen Fairwork principle.
- **3 – Very Good:** Your visuals are clear and focused (no overload); you walk the audience through what each figure or theme shows; you connect findings logically to Fairwork and to what others might expect or assume.
- **4 – Excellent:** You make very effective use of a small dataset; each chart, table, or quote slide has a clear message; you interpret patterns carefully, acknowledge uncertainty, and draw insightful implications for Fairwork without over-claiming.

Criterion 4: Communication & Reflexivity – *How you design and deliver the talk, and how you reflect aloud on limits and learning.*

- **0 – Fail:** The talk is very hard to follow (no structure, major timing issues); slides are chaotic or unreadable; you do not mention limitations or what you learned; serious professionalism issues.
- **1 – Pass:** The presentation roughly follows a structure (topic–method–results–end), but some parts are rushed or unclear; slides are text-heavy but legible; you mostly read from slides; limitations are only briefly mentioned.
- **2 – Good:** The talk has a clear beginning, middle, and end; you stay close to time; slides support rather than distract (short text, some visuals); you identify key limitations and one or two things you would do differently next time.
- **3 – Very Good:** Delivery is confident and audience-aware (eye contact, pacing, signposting); slides are clean and well-designed; you reflect concretely on ethical or practical challenges and how you handled them.
- **4 – Excellent:** The presentation is highly clear, engaging, and professional; visuals and speech work tightly together; you offer a thoughtful, honest reflection on your positionality, choices, and constraints, and what this project taught you about Fairwork-style research

Contact

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